



Figure 1: An open source operating system desktop



Figure 2: LibreOffice opening screen

manipulating images, it must enable us to manage money, and we must be capable of communicating and scheduling it. Some of these must-haves prescribe that we have sound tools to work with. But don't ever think that Microsoft and other makers of licensed software are the only options when it comes to productivity. The open source software tools are also absolutely suited to assist you in getting your job done.

Open source productivity tools

Let us now look at five such productivity tools.

LibreOffice

LibreOffice is open source software that is equivalent to Microsoft Office. It basically comprises word processing, spreadsheets, presentations and database tools. All the tools in it are compatible with their Microsoft Office equivalents and rigorously follow open standards. LibreOffice is free of cost and is accessible across all platforms.

Features: In LibreOffice, a written document can be categorised into classes on the basis of TSCP standards. Also, many digital signatures and statements are now backed up, along with importation and exportation of signatures from OOXML records.

Pros: 1. Great assist with user manuals.
2. Properties like the text to columns and pivot arrays are accessible in LibreOffice; these are enough for meeting the day-to-day requirements of the average user.

Cons: 1. LibreCalc looks unappealing.
2. It was known to crash when over 100,000 rows of data were pasted.

The GIMP

The GIMP is one of the most versatile image-editing/creating tools in the open source industry, comparable to Photoshop. Many tasks in the GIMP might take a couple of more steps than Photoshop does, but in the end, the job gets done.

Features: The GIMP has almost the same impressive features as Photoshop, like filters, brushes, basic editing, colour correction, etc. It is not quite as smooth, but can complete the job decently.

Pros: 1. It is freely available.
2. You can customise it with the available plug-ins and add-ons.
3. It runs on multiple platforms.



Figure 3: The GIMP screen

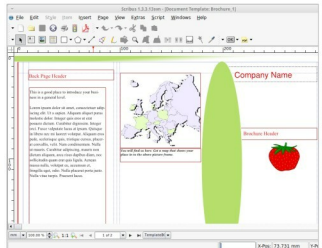


Figure 4: The Scribus window

Cons: 1. It has a steep learning curve.
2. There is no customer support.
3. It can be cracked and has lots of clutter.

Scribus

Scribus is the simplest and smartest mode of making PDF documents in Linux. This open source tool is not only accessible to the Linux world; you can even enjoy the freedom of making PDF documents on Mac and Windows. With an easy user interface and all the attributes you'd require in a PDF creation tool, Scribus will assist you to complete the job fast and easily.

Features: It makes single or multiple written documents that incorporate text, representations of vector artworks, and also foreign images from mainstream requests.

Pros: 1. Users enjoy complete freedom to do whatever they want to do.
2. With a beautiful interface, it ensures user-friendly interaction.
3. Being a free program, it is very lightweight.

Cons: 1. It does not incorporate a spellcheck option.
2. Pictures are required to be in the same document with the same location.